

RD/RDN and CNS Certifications

Certification	Required Degree	Supervised Practice Program	National Exam	Continuing Education (CE)
RD/RDN	Have a bachelor's degree from a university or college accredited by the Accreditation Council for Education in Nutrition and Dietetics (ACEND®). A Masters degree will be required for new applicants as of January 1, 2024.	Complete a 6- to 12-month ACEND®-accredited supervised practice program at a health care facility, community agency, or a foodservice corporation combined with undergraduate or graduate studies.	Must pass a national exam in addition to completing their supervised practice to receive credentials.	Must complete appropriate CE requirements to maintain an active credential.
CNS	Have either a Master of Science or doctoral degree in a field of nutrition or a related field from a regionally accredited college or university in the United States, or its foreign equivalent. Or Have a doctoral degree in a field of clinical healthcare from a regionally accredited college or university in the United States, or its foreign equivalent. Push-ups, as many reps as possible	Complete 1,000 hours of supervised practice by a CNS board-approved supervisor. The hours focus on: ● personalized nutrition assessment and interpretation; ● nutrition intervention, education, counseling, and ongoing care; and ● personalized nutrition monitoring and evaluation.	Must pass a national exam in addition to completing their supervised practice to receive credentials.	Must complete appropriate CE requirements to maintain an active credential.

Adapted from the websites for the Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics (Registered Dietitian Nutritionist Fact Sheet, n.d.) and the American Nutrition Association (Nutritionists & Health Professionals | American Nutrition Association, n.d.).